

richer by the day, often prospering at the cost of people whom they represent in Parliament and assemblies. With an unending greed, these politicians have no remorse about their misdeeds. If we pool half the obscene amount of wealth that they possess, India's poverty will become a thing of the past.

SUSHILA RAMAN,
via www.indiatoday.in

Small Measures

Pakistan wants more proof, knowing well that asking for it will only frustrate India ("A Question of Answers", March 2). It is futile to expect Pakistan to take any action against those who were directly or indirectly involved in the 26/11 attacks. The only way forward is for the international community to come together and take necessary action against terror elements in Pakistan.

J. AKSHOBHYA,
via www.indiatoday.in

Web of Deceit

The time has come for the mercurial Mayawati to concentrate on governing the most populous state of the nation instead of nurturing hopes of coming to power in Delhi ("Getting Down to Business", March 2). Uttar Pradesh is one of the most lawless and backward states with little hope of change in its state of affairs. Her two considerations in decision-making

are caste and religion. Her developmental initiatives are also lopsided. She loves blowing her own trumpet, talking only about what all she has done so far, but there's no mention of all that is still not done.

D.B.N. MURTHY,
via www.indiatoday.in

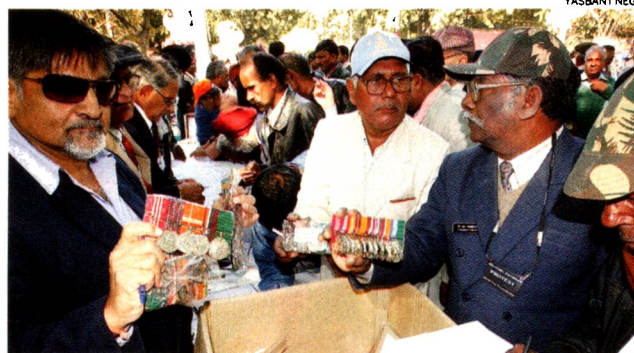
Terror Trail

In its blind urge to gain a foothold in Afghanistan, Pakistan's ISI had created a Frankenstein in the shape of the Taliban

Bengal Crusade

Mamata Banerjee is leaving no stone unturned to ensure that West Bengal goes back to the dark ages ("Crumbling Fortress", February 23). If this goes on, Bengal will be one of the most backward states. Banerjee's fight against the Left has changed into a crusade against development which is certainly not in the best interests of the state.

SNEHAL BISWAS,
via www.indiatoday.in



YASBANT NEGI

Retired soldiers deserve better treatment. Why is the Government not doing anything to ensure that these army men get their due—one rank one pension?

KARNAM SINGH, via www.indiatoday.in

("March of the Taliban", March 2). If the US wants to save Pakistan, it must destroy the Taliban, or it is bound to fail in the fight against Jihadi terrorism. The Jihadi elements crawling amongst us must be identified and eliminated at the earliest.

A.K. SHARMA,
via www.indiatoday.in

Merciless Tigers

The LTTE is a brutal terrorist organisation that doesn't care for human lives and uses women and children to carry out horrific acts ("In the Line of Fire", February 16). Sympathy for them is certainly misplaced.

BISHAN SAHAI,
via www.indiatoday.in

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30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

APRIL 16-30, 1979

A Brilliant Opportunist

Bhutto may be dead, but the legacy of the man is potentially so enormous that his name is bound to be remembered much longer than any of his predecessors. Barely weeks before his ignominious death, Bhutto had penned his personal epitaph from his death cell in Rawalpindi prison—"A poet and a revolutionary—that is what I have been all these years, and that is how I shall remain till the last breath is gone from my body." But right through his mercurial political career, Bhutto remained a mass of contradictions. A man of extremes, Bhutto himself was lauded or damned in extremist terms. To the man who ordered his execution, General Zia, Bhutto was the personification of evil, guilty of innumerable murders. To his political opponents, he was the slipperiest of customers. But to many Pakistanis, he was a demi-God, the saviour of the nation.

Dilip Bobb



BHUTTO